

*Insurance.* Within this folder, you'll need separate folders for auto, home, rental, life, health, and disability insurance. Keep your policies, descriptive literature, copies of any claims that you make, and statements of reimbursements.

*Individual retirement accounts (IRAs).* Hold on to your statements. If you have different types of IRAs, you'll need separate folders for each. See Chapters 6 and 9 for details.

*Mortgage interest payments.* If you own a home, hold on to statements related to all payments because they may be tax-deductible.

*Mutual funds.* File your year-end transaction statements.

*Personal documents.* Store important documents such as your passport, Social Security card, and marriage certificate here.

*Property tax/real estate tax.* These payments are tax-deductible, so hold on to statements related to them.

*Retirement plan statements.* Keep all "summary plan descriptions" you receive from your employer, and save quarterly statements from your retirement savings plan. Also hang on to documents relating to other employee benefits, such as profit-sharing plans.

*Salary.* Keep your biweekly or monthly pay stubs, your year-end pay form, and any written information you receive regarding your bonus.

*Student loans.* Save your original loan agreement and your monthly statements. A portion of the interest you pay every month may be tax-deductible.

*Tax-deductible items (miscellaneous).* If you don't have many deductible expenses, use this as a catch-all folder. Otherwise, you may want to set up separate folders for each specific type of deduction you can take. (See Chapter 9 for details on these deductions.)

*Tax returns.* Each January you receive W-2s from your employer and 1099s from a variety of sources including employers, banks, and mutual fund companies. Save them in this file. (You'll have to scan them if you want to store them electronically.) Also hold on to